

without due process. In protest, there was a fresh onslaught of train sabotage. The Government of Punjab and the controversial Punjab governor, Sir Michael O'Dwyer, who would soon become infamous for his role in the Jallianwala Massacre (1919) in Amritsar, recorded a series of attacks during this period.

Railway stations were burnt, lines destroyed, and attempts were made to derail trains. There were reports of an attack on a railway workshop, a train carrying British troops, and even a mob setting fire to railway bridges at Wazirabad, near New Delhi. O'Dwyer later wrote in his autobiography *India As I Knew It* that this indicated "a prearranged design to immobilise our troops and isolate the main centres of rebellion".

In 1922, after Gandhi called off the Non-cooperation movement, there was growing dissatisfaction among revolutionary factions. It was during this time in 1925 that the Hindustan Republican Association (HRA) carried out the daring [Kakori Robbery](#). Later reports, by way of a confession, indicated that there had been plans to blow up the Simon Commission special train (1928) as well. The Simon Commission was a group of British Members of Parliament who had been sent to India to report on constitutional reforms in the country. The plan, had it succeeded, would have been rather high-profile. The railways continued to be targeted throughout the 1942 Quit India movement. A few dacoities, similar to Kakori took place at this time, in the central and eastern United Provinces. On 9 July 1940, the 170 Down Passenger train from Lucknow to Mughalsarai was stopped and its mail van ransacked for Rs 2,226 and 8 annas. The money was used to buy firearms and to print a pamphlet called "Ranbheri" (the bugle war cry).

With the clarity of hindsight, historians would later observe that the physical attacks on the railways did not mean that the people objected to the railways. In fact, everyone, even the revolutionaries and freedom fighters relied on the trains – for travel, for the swift and efficient execution of their plans, and often, in the case of some, for making quick getaways.